ABSTRACT OF THE DISCLOSURE

A signals intelligence system and method for identifying a specific target's encrypted data streams without decrypting the traffic. The method works by forcing the target's device to embed a unique, statistically rare string of characters or symbols, known as a "cryptographic anchor," into its outgoing plaintext data before encryption. A network monitoring system, positioned to observe large volumes of aggregated encrypted traffic, performs a lightweight scan for the known bit-pattern of the cryptographic anchor. A match allows the system to flag a specific encrypted stream as originating from the target. This method avoids computationally expensive decryption of all traffic and allows for the efficient identification and prioritization of a target's communications for further analysis or action.